

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

In this lesson, we focus on the concept of key squares when the pawn has not yet reached the 6th rank. The key squares are two ranks ahead of the pawn, and if the strong king occupies one of these squares, the pawn will promote. The lesson illustrates how to maneuver the king to occupy these key squares while preventing the opponent's king from doing the same.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White aims to occupy the key squares to ensure the pawn can promote, while Black seeks to prevent this by occupying the same squares.

STRATEGY

Identify and control key squares that allow the pawn to promote. The white king must occupy these squares while preventing the black king from doing the same. This requires strategic maneuvering and awareness of the opponent's moves.

MOVES

First, move your king to f6 to occupy one of the key squares. If the black king moves to e8, you can advance the pawn. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kf6 Ke8 2. Kg7! 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson emphasizes the importance of key squares and how controlling them can lead to pawn promotion. It also discusses the role of opposition in determining the outcome of the endgame.